

MASTER NOTE FOR THIRD ACADEMIC SESSION

GRADE 8

Week One

Grammar: Use of conjunctions

Reading Comprehension

Composition: Paragraphing (development of paragraph)

Literature: Review of literary terms/devices

Week Two

Grammar: Conjunctions

Reading Comprehension

Literature: Summary of recommended prose text

Composition: Paragraphing (development of paragraph)

Week Three

Grammar: Tenses (revision)

Reading Comprehension

Essay Writing: Narrative Essay

Literature: Analysis of recommended text

Week Four

Grammar: Use of Have, has and had and the 'be' verbs

Reading Comprehension

Vocabulary Development: Politics/Human Rights

Essay Writing: Expository essay

Week Five

Grammar: Prepositions

Reading Comprehension

Composition: Narrative essay

Literature: Analysis of recommended poem

Week Six

Grammar: Antonyms and synonyms

Vocabulary Development: Tourism

WEEK Seven

MIDTERM BREAK

Week Eight

Grammar: Affix

Reading Comprehension

Composition: Write a composition on the topic "The rich also cry."

Literature: Analysis of drama text.

Week Nine

Grammar: Question tags

Reading comprehension: review of language skill.

Literature: Analysis of drama text.

Week Ten - Eleven

Revision and examination

Week One

Grammar: Use of conjunctions

Reading Comprehension

Composition: Paragraphing (development of paragraph)

Literature: Review of literary terms/devices

LESSON 1: GRAMMAR

TOPIC: USE OF CONJUNCTIONS (ALTHOUGH AND WHEREAS)

TOPIC: CONJUNCTIONS

1. Definition of a Conjunction

A conjunction is a word used to join words, phrases, or clauses together in a sentence. In simple terms, conjunctions are “joining words.”

Examples:

1. I bought bread and butter.
2. She was tired but she continued working.
3. We stayed at home because it was raining.

2. Uses of Conjunctions

Conjunctions help us to:

1. Add information
Example: Mary and John came to school.
2. Show contrast (difference)
Example: He is rich but unhappy.
3. Give reasons
Example: She cried because she was hurt.
4. Show choice or alternatives
Example: You can have tea or coffee.
5. Show time
Example: I will call you when I arrive.
6. Show condition
Example: I will go if you go with me.
7. Make sentences flow better
They help avoid short, choppy sentences.

Types of Conjunctions

There are three main types of conjunctions:

Coordinating Conjunctions

These conjunctions join words or clauses of equal importance.

You can remember them using the acronym: FANBOYS

- a. For
- b. And
- c. Nor
- d. But
- e. Or
- f. Yet
- g. So

Examples:

- a. I wanted to go, but it was late.
- b. She likes rice and beans.
- c. Hurry up, or you will miss the bus.

B. Subordinating Conjunctions

These join a main clause (independent clause) to a subordinate clause (dependent clause).

They show relationships like time, reason, condition, result, etc.

Common examples:

because, although, if, when, while, since, unless, before, after

Examples:

- a. I stayed indoors because it was raining.
- b. Although he is young, he is very wise.
- c. I will help you if you ask me.

C. Correlative Conjunctions

These are used in pairs to join equal parts of a sentence.

Common pairs:

- a. either...or
- b. neither...nor
- c. both...and
- d. not only...but also

Examples:

- a. Either you study hard or you fail.
- b. Both the teacher and the students were present.
- c. She is not only intelligent but also hardworking.

4. Important Notes

- a. A conjunction helps to avoid repetition.
- b. Do not overuse conjunctions in a sentence.

- c. Ensure correct punctuation when joining clauses.

5. Examples in Sentences

- a. The boy is poor but honest.
- b. I didn't come to school because I was sick.
- c. Although it was raining, they continued playing.
- d. You can stay here or go home.

6. Common Errors to Avoid

Wrong: Because he was tired. (Incomplete sentence)

Correct: He slept because he was tired.

Wrong: She likes rice and but beans.

Correct: She likes rice and beans.

Exercise

A. Fill in the blanks with suitable conjunctions:

- 1. I will go ____ you come with me.
- 2. She is poor ____ happy.
- 3. We stayed indoors ____ it was raining.
- 4. You can take tea ____ coffee.

B. State the type of conjunction used:

- 1. I was late because of traffic.
- 2. He tried hard but failed.
- 3. Either you apologize or you leave.

TOPIC: PARAGRAPHING

Definition of a Paragraph

A paragraph is a group of sentences that develop one main idea. It begins with a topic sentence and is supported by other sentences that explain or give more details.

Example:

My school is very beautiful. It has large classrooms and a clean environment. The teachers are friendly and hardworking. I enjoy learning there.

Parts of a Paragraph

A good paragraph is made up of three main parts:

- i. Topic Sentence

This is the first sentence of the paragraph. It introduces the main idea, in other words, a topic sentence is the main sentence in a paragraph that tells the reader what the paragraph is about. It usually comes at the beginning of the paragraph.

Simple Explanation

Think of a topic sentence as a headline for your paragraph. It introduces the main idea, while the other sentences give more details.

Example

Topic sentence:

My school is a wonderful place to learn.

Supporting sentences:

- a. The teachers are very friendly.
- b. The classrooms are neat and spacious.
- c. There are many learning materials available.

Key Features of a Topic Sentence

A good topic sentence:

- a. States the main idea clearly
- b. Is not too long or too short
- c. Is specific, not too general

Another Example

Playing football is good for students.

(All other sentences in the paragraph will explain why or how football is good.)

Example:

Football is my favourite sport.

Supporting Sentences

These sentences explain, describe, or give details about the topic sentence.

They may include examples, reasons, facts, explanations, etc.

Example:

- a. I play it every weekend with my friends.
- b. It helps me stay fit and active.
- c. I also enjoy watching matches on television.

Concluding sentence: This is the last sentence. It summarises the paragraph or gives a final thought.

Example

That is why football is very important to me.

LITERATURE

TOPIC: LITERARY TERMS/DEVICES

Objectives: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- i. Define literary terms and figures of speech
- ii. Define all the literary terms and figures of speech under study.
- iii. Identify them in any work of art.

CONTENT:

LITERARY TERMS

FLASHBACK: A flashback is an interruption in a narrative that depicts events that have already occurred, either before the present time or before the time at which the narration takes place.

IRONY: is when a statement is used to express an opposite meaning than the one literally expressed by it. This occurs when the opposite of what is expected is realized.

Examples

Paul is the most intelligent boy in the class yet he comes last.

Peter is very wealthy yet he borrows from beggars.

There are three types of irony

VERBAL IRONY: this means when someone says something but means the opposite (similar to sarcasm)

SITUATIONAL IRONY: This is when something happens that's the opposite of what was expected or intended to happen.

DRAMATIC IRONY: When the audience is aware of the true intentions or outcomes, while the characters are not.

ALLEGORY: An allegory is a story that is used to represent a more general message about real-life (historical) issues and/ or events. It is typically an entire book, novel, play, etc.

MOOD: Mood is a general feeling the writer wants the audience to have. The writer can achieve this through description, setting, dialogue, and word choice.

ASSIGNMENT

Define Character and Characterisation.

FIGURES OF SPEECH

The figures of speech are various devices that are used to give non-literal meanings. They are used to create rhetoric effect. There are a number of figures of speech in literature, but a few are used in the English language tests. Some of them include the following:

- | | |
|------------------------|--------------|
| 1) Simile | 2) Metaphor |
| 3) Personification | 4) Hyperbole |
| 5) Euphemism | |
| 6) Rhetorical question | |
| 7) Onomatopoeia | |

Simile: this is a form of comparison between two things, which are generally not alike but in a particular aspect are alike. These things are compared using 'as' and 'like'. Examples: Damilola is like a dove. (Meaning Damilola is gentle). Kayode is as fast as a hare. (Meaning Kayode is very fast).

Metaphor: this is also a type of comparison but unlike the simile, it's a direct comparison. While the simile says someone is like something else, the metaphor says the person is the exact thing. It is used without the use of either 'like' or 'as'.

Examples:

Damilola is a dove.

Kayode is a hare.

Hyperbole: this is a deliberate exaggeration of fact or truth. It is otherwise called overstatement.

Examples:

I have warned you a million and one times.

He could devour a mountain of rice if he is hungry.

Euphemism: it is a subtle way to say something unpleasant in a pleasant manner.

Examples:

May I visit the comfort station? (Meaning "may I go to the toilet?").

The king has kicked the bucket. (Meaning "the king is dead").

Rhetorical Question: this is a question that does not necessarily need an answer. It is used for curiosity and emphasis sake.

Examples

Are you out of your mind?

Is God not faithful?

Onomatopoeia: this is a figure of speech that has its meaning in sound.

Examples

The crowing of cocks.

The booming of guns.

Personification: this is the figure of speech that gives inanimate objects the animate qualities.

Examples:

The sky is crying. (Meaning "it is raining").

His pen is dancing on the paper. (Meaning "he is writing").

Assignment.

1. Give an example of the following figures of speech
 - a. Personification
 - b. Simile
 - c. Oxymoron
 - d. Metaphor
 - e. Onomatopoeia

WEEK 2

LESSON 1: GRAMMAR

Week Two

Grammar: Conjunctions

Reading Comprehension

Literature: Summary of recommended prose text

Composition: Paragraphing (development of paragraph)

Paragraphs Continued: How Paragraphs Are Built (Steps in Writing a Paragraph)

1. Choose a Topic

Decide what you want to write about.

Example topics

- a. My Best Friend
- b. My School
- c. A Memorable Day

2. Think of Main Ideas

Write down points related to your topic.

3. Write a Topic Sentence

Introduce the main idea clearly.

4. Add Supporting Details

Explain your idea using examples, descriptions, reasons

5. Arrange Ideas Logically

Make sure your ideas flow in a clear order:

From simple to complex

From general to specific

6. Write a Concluding Sentence

End the paragraph properly.

4. Qualities of a Good Paragraph

A good paragraph should have:

Unity

All sentences must relate to one main idea.

Wrong: Mixing different ideas

Correct: Focus on one topic only

B. Coherence

Ideas should be well organised and flow smoothly.

Use linking words like:

and, but, because, however, also

C. Adequate Development

The paragraph should have enough details to explain the idea clearly.

D. Correct Grammar and Punctuation

Use proper:

- a. Capital letters
- b. Full stops
- c. Correct spelling

5. Types of Paragraphs

A. Narrative Paragraph

Tells a story or event.

Example:

A story about your holiday.

B. Descriptive Paragraph

Describes a person, place, or thing.

Example:

Describing your classroom.

C. Expository Paragraph

Explains or gives information.

Example:

How to cook rice.

D. Argumentative Paragraph

Gives opinions and supports them.

Example:

Why students should wear uniforms.

Example of a Complete Paragraph: My best friend is a very kind person. She always helps me with my schoolwork when I find it difficult. She is honest and never tells lies. We play together during break time and share our lunch. I am happy to have such a wonderful friend.

7. Common Errors to Avoid

Writing too many ideas in one paragraph. Focus on one idea

No topic sentence. Start with a clear main idea.

Poor organization. Arrange ideas logically

No conclusion. End with a proper closing sentence

8. Exercise

Write a paragraph (8–10 sentences) on any of the following topics:

- a. My Favourite Teacher
- b. A Visit to the Market
- c. Why I Love My School

Identify the parts of the paragraph below:

Lagos is a busy city. Many people live and work there every day. The roads are always full of cars and buses. There are many markets and offices. It is one of the most active cities in Nigeria.

Topic sentence: _____

Supporting sentences: _____

Concluding sentence: _____

Conclusion

Paragraphing is an important writing skill. It helps you to organise your ideas clearly so that readers can easily understand your message.

LITERATURE

TOPIC: POPULAR THEMES IN MYTHS AND LEGEND

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

Define theme

Mention some of the popular themes in myths

Discuss some of the popular themes in legends.

CONTENT:

Myths and legends are important to us today for a number of reasons. They have value as literature, offering timeless and universal themes; they give us insight into other times and places; and they help us to see how much humankind had and has in common.

The themes of myths and legends are the same as those that are present in all great literature, just a few of which are man versus man, man versus nature, man versus the gods, man on a quest, family conflict, and coming of age. Most myths and legends include at least one of these great themes and often several. These are in the earliest "stories," the ancestors of all literature that we read today. Even aside from the beauty and creativity of these stories, which alone make them worthy of study, they enrich our study of literature today to see its earliest roots.

Every culture has its own mythology and legends and these reflect the geography of the culture, the values of the culture, and the history of the culture. Japanese creation myths, for example, reflect the fact that Japan is an island nation, and the sea and its creatures play an important part in these myths. Myths can also tell us what a culture considers ethical, significant, and central to its ideologies, giving us insight into another culture. A culture's myths, such as those of some Native Americans, tell us something about its history, the history of peoples that were hunters and gatherers, people whose governing forms did not sanction private ownership of land or disrespect the natural world. Each myth you read has something to tell you about another culture.

But in spite of the differences we see in various myths and legends, it is good to know that deep down, people are the same. We want to know how we came to be, we want to understand the natural world around us, and we yearn for some deity we can praise and blame.

Some popular themes in myths and legends include:

1. Heroism
2. Faith
3. Fate
4. Love
5. Sacrifice
6. Generosity

GRAMMAR

VERBS: USE OF HAVE, HAS AND HAD

Objectives: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- i. Identify the figure of speech these words are.
- ii. Use them in sentence construction.
- iii. State their differences.

CONTENT:

The three belong to the family of the verbs 'to-have' under the primary auxiliary verbs. 'Has' is used when the subject of the sentence is singular, expressing a present tense while 'Have' is used when the subject of the sentence is plural and also expresses the present tense. 'Had' is the past form/tense of both has/have. It is used with both singular and plural subjects.

- **PRESENT TENSE:**

I/you/we/they = have

he/she/it/Tobi /director= has

- **PAST TENSE (SIMPLE)**

I/you/we/they/he/she/it/Ada/chairman = had

- **FUTURE TENSE (SIMPLE)**

I/you/we/they/he/she/it/Ada/director = will have

- **PRESENT PERFECT**

'Have' or 'Has' is used with a past participle to form the present perfect tense.

- **PAST PERFECT**

The past perfect is formed with 'had' and a past participle.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Subject + have / has + been + Present Participle (verb + ing)

- **PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS**

Subject + had + been + Present Participle (verb + ing)

- **FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS**

Subject + will + have + been + Present Participle (verb + ing)

Note: The Present Participle and Past Participle for the verb "be" (is, am, are) is been.

Here are some sentence examples to help portray the differences.

Have

I have a great job.

I have an Oxford dictionary.

I have blue eyes.

I have a great boss.

Has

She has a horrible job.

He has the biggest oxford dictionary.

She has green eyes.

He has a mean boss.

Had

I had a great job before the economic crisis. Now I am unemployed.

He had an Oxford dictionary but someone stole it last week.

I had blue eyes when I was born but they changed to brown when I was two years old.

I had a great boss in my old company.

ASSIGNMENT.

Change the following sentences to present perfect and past perfect tenses.

1. The cat drinks milk.
2. He writes letters.
3. She bakes cake.
4. Assembly begins at 8 am.
5. She cooks for a living.

TOPIC: LETTER WRITING (FORMAL)

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- i. Define letter writing
- ii. Define formal letter.
- iii. Mention the features of a formal letter.

iv. Mention the category of people formal letter is written to.

CONTENT:

A formal letter is a letter one writes to offices to

- a. request for something
- b. apply for a job
- c. complain about faulty purchases
- d. give your opinion on a controversial issue.

Such letters are usually written to business houses, ministries, institutions and newspaper houses. They are addressed to heads of such places, such as the chairman; the Registrar; the Principal; the Editor, etc. A formal letter is also known as an official letter or an impersonal letter.

In this regard, you must be strictly official. Go straight to the point and be brief. Use official language – no short forms, no slang, no greetings.

Alpha Choice Innovative Academy;
Arepo,
Ogun state.
25th May, 2024.

The Editor,
Vanguard Newspapers,
P.M.B. 1007,
Apapa,
Lagos State.

Sir,

Examination Malpractice – Immediate Action Now!

I wish to contribute to the on-going debate in your newspaper on how to stop examination malpractice in our society. It is very sad and disgraceful that up till now, we have not found a solution to that problem.

I agree with Mr. David Oke, which article captioned “More Drastic Steps” appeared in your issue of 2nd August, that stricter measures be applied; not minding whose child is affected. The law against examination malpractice should not exempt anybody and must be applied, if we are serious.

Drastic measures, if taken, will serve as deterrents and prevent a lot more from involving themselves in examination malpractice.

Action now, if we want to curb examination malpractice!

Yours faithfully,

Mba Eunice

Essential Tips

Writing Formal Letters

1. Use two addresses, the writer's address and the recipient's address.
2. Punctuate those addresses well. No date after the second address.
3. Open with "Sir", "Madam", or "Dear Sir", "Dear Madam".
4. Give a heading/title of your letter and underline. You can write all in capital letters and then you do not underline.
5. Go straight to the point. No exchange of pleasantries.
6. Be official. No short forms, no slang, no colloquial expressions. Be brief, no embellishments.
7. Close with "Yours faithfully" – capital "Y" small "f", then comma.
8. Write your signature.
9. Write your full names – Your name and your surname followed by a full stop.

ASSIGNMENT.

Write a letter to the chairman of your local government council, expressing your dissatisfaction with the achievement of his regime so far, and pointing out two major problems of your people which require his urgent attention.

WEEK 4

LESSON 1 GRAMMAR

Topic: Use of Have, Has, Had and the 'Be' verbs.

Reference is made to the previous lessons.

LESSON 2 VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

TOPIC: HUMAN RIGHTS.

Objectives:

- i. Define the term "Human right"
- ii. Mention words associated with human right.
- iii. Define and use these words in sentence construction.

CONTENT:

VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

WORDS ASSOCIATED WITH HUMAN RIGHTS

Peace
morality
torture

secularity
slavery.
repression
freedom
equality
constitutional
dissidents
non proliferation
atrocities
rapporteur.
humanitarianism.
Bioethics
governance
treaties
demobilization
norm
egalitarianism
femicide
repressiveness.
anthropoid
homicide
homophobe
pedophile
equality
son proliferation
sovereignty
peace keeping
conscience
Imperialism
Xenophobe
ombudswoman
manscape.
freedom of speech
Violation

Assignment.

Use these terms in your own sentence.

- 1) Violation
- 2) Conscience
- 3) Sovereignty
- 4) Imperialism
- 5) Peace keeping

LESSON 3

TOPIC: EXPOSITORY ESSAY

Objectives: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- i. Define expository essay.
- ii. Mention the features of an expository essay.
- iii. Write a good expository essay.

CONTENT:

An expository essay is a genre of writing which tends to explain, illustrate, clarify, or explicate something in a way that it becomes clear for reader. Therefore, it becomes clear for readers.

Useful hints on how to write a good expository essay

1. Discuss at length the topic you are asked to discuss. In most cases, you are expected to unfold the bad and good consequences of the topic.
2. There should be an introduction and conclusion. The introduction must briefly explain the main idea of the essay and it must be followed by the body of the essay.
3. You are expected to arrange your points or ideas in a logical sequence.
4. Your sentence should be variety of long and short sentence.
5. Make use of phrases or word linkers to link your paragraph with one another.
6. Clarity of expression is important. You must make sure that you state your facts, instances.
7. Your vocabulary should be carefully chosen for effectiveness, especially when you are writing on a topic that has a formal register.
8. Your language should be formal; you should avoid slangs, clothes, unidiomatic expressions and meaningless phrases.

ASSIGNMENT

Write an expository essay titled “Juvenile delinquencies; causes, effect and solution”.

WEEK 5

LESSON 1: GRAMMAR

TOPIC: VERBS

Verbs are words that express an action or a state of being.

Examples

Ade killed the goat. ('killed' is expressing an action in the sentence)

They are humans. ('are' is a “be” verb, expressing an existence)

She is a woman. ('is' is a 'be' verb expressing an existence)

There are different types of verbs, namely:

The regular and irregular verbs

The transitive and intransitive verb

The auxiliary verb

The lexical/main verbs

LESSON 2:

TOPIC: VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

SUB TOPIC: CONFLICT RESOLUTION

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- 1) Define conflict resolution
- 2) Mention words associated with conflict resolution
- 3) Define and use the words in sentence examples.

Dispute

Conflict

Negotiation.

Dogfight

Feud

Duel

Confrontational

Dissonance

Feral

Honourably

Godly

Struggle

Compatibility

Empathy

Enlightenment

Litigation

Belligerent

Fracas

Biff

Strong bone

Controversial

Vie

Cockfight

Wardom

Disputation

Strife

Tiff

Medley

Quarreler

Cyberwar

Warmonger

Proxy war.

Distraught

Blind trust.

Assignment.

Look up the dictionary for the meaning of the following words and use each of them in sentence example.

- 1) Tiff
- 2) Warmonger
- 3) Cockfight
- 4) Fracas
- 5) Duel

LESSON 3**TOPIC: COMPOSITION****SUBTOPIC: DESCRIPTIVE ESSAY**

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to

- 1) Define descriptive essay.
- 2) Mention the features of a descriptive essay.
- 3) Write a model descriptive essay.

CONTENT

A descriptive essay describes so many things such as person, a place, a scene, an event or an object. A good descriptive essay brings what is described so close that the person to whom we describe will have a clear picture of what object or person. Description is writing what something or somebody is.

Listeners or readers will understand you better when you are able to describe well, using appropriate words.

In the same manner as other types of essays, your writing must have introduction, body and conclusion.

1) In the introductory paragraph, you mention the scene, object or person you want to describe, the general features and the outward appearance. If you are describing a place.

2] Make use of well-developed paragraphs

3] There must be logical sequence of arrangement of the features and qualities of what you are describing.

4] Your paragraphs must be effectively linked for unity and coherence.

5] Make use of appropriate words which will best convey your description to your readers.

6] There must be clarity of expression.

7] Probe yourself by generating questions that will help you develop the essay. These questions will lead you to write the required essay length.

EXERCISE

1) Describe how your favourite meal is prepared.

WEEK 6

LESSON 1 GRAMMAR SYNONYMS AND ANTONYMS

Objectives: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- i. Define synonyms and antonyms
- ii. Give word examples and their synonyms and antonyms.
- iii. Use each word in a sentence construction.
- iv.

CONTENT

SYNONYMS

Generally, synonyms are looked at as words, whose meanings are the same. Although linguists are in agreement that no two words have exactly the same meaning in the English language. The correct way to define synonyms, therefore, should be --- **words that have almost identical/similar meanings**, although they may have subtle differences. Let us see these words--- **wealthy** and **rich** as examples. Both have almost identical meanings, yet they have a subtle difference; whereas the former refers to a position of affluence and apply mainly to human beings, the latter has its meaning extended to having any ingredient or quality in great abundance, productive, etc. It can therefore be applied to even inanimate things; hence, we may say 'rich soil', 'rich tea', 'rich song', etc.

Examples.

Abandon- desert, forsake, leave

Abode- dwelling- place, home, habitation, residence

Actual- existing, real

Ally- friend, helper, partner.

Anxiety- misgiving, uneasiness.

Candid- frank, outspoken, sincere, straightforward.

Charity- benevolent, philanthropy

Fussy- fastidious, particular, meticulous.

Gay- blithe, cheerful, jolly, merry.

Gloom- darkness, depression, melancholy.

govern- control, rule

Increase- amplify, augment, expand, magnify.

see- behold, discern, perceive, scan

trick- deception, pretense, hypocrisy

suitable- appropriate, befitting

Ugly- grotesque, horrid, unsightful.

Souvenir- memento, relic, remembrance.

Rash- careless, hasty, reckless

Joke- banter, jest.

Infinite- boundless, endless.

Assignment.

Write out the synonyms of the following words.

- 1) calamity
- 2) gloom
- 3) thrifty
- 4) foreboding
- 5) mitigate
- 6) Incarcerate
- 7) assemble
- 8) flimsy
- 9) revolt
- 10) destitute.**

Antonyms

Antonyms explain the idea of oppositeness. But, just as we mentioned while treating synonyms, there's no perfect antonym. To be free from the difficulty of antonyms, students should first learn how the words are formed.

Opposites (antonyms) are most commonly formed by adding PREFIXES to root words

e.g. a + moral = amoral

il + legal = illegal

im + possible = impossible

non + sense = nonsense

un + usual = unusual

in + active = inactive

ir + relevant = irrelevant

dis + honest = dishonest

Other prefixes to form opposites are dis – (dishonorable), in - (incomplete), ir – (irresponsible)

The suffix – less is also used to form antonyms:

e.g. mother + less = motherless

Point + less = pointless

Value + less = valueless

Always check the meaning of words before you use them.

Give the meaning and antonyms of each of the following words.

- (i) recalcitrant
- (ii) opaque
- (iii) benediction
- (iv) recommendation
- (v) accordance

LESSON 2

TOPIC: WORDS ASSOCIATED WITH RELIGION

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- 1) Define religion
- 2) Mention words associated with religion
- 3) Define each of these words
- 4) Use religious terms in sentence construction.

VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: RELIGION.

Minority

Martyr

Persecution

Proselyte

Faithful

Religionless

Dissidence

Humanism

Spirituality

Clergy

Bigot

Traditionalism

Impious

Orthodox

Prejudice

Theologian

Profession

Sect

Scripture

Nullification

Pagan

Synagogue

Renegade

Revival

Jew

Judaism

sacred
Holy
Infidel
Muslim
Islam
Cult
Heathen
Secularism
Devout
Christiandom
Messiah
Apostate

Assignment

Write out the meaning of these religious terms.

- 1) Catechism
- 2) Missionary
- 3) Scripture
- 4) Latitudinarian.

WEEK 7 MID TERM BREAK

WEEK 8

LESSON 1: GRAMMAR

TOPIC: PREFIX AND SUFFIX

Essential Questions:

- i. What is a Prefix?
- ii. What is a suffix?
- iii. How are they used?

CONTENT:

Words with a different grammatical form or meaning can be derived from a base word using prefixes and suffixes. By understanding how these prefixes and suffixes work, it is often easier to deal with unknown vocabulary. You can sometimes see what part of

speech a word is (verb, noun, adjective etc.), or additional information that a prefix may give.

1. Changes in grammatical form.

The noun 'power' can be used as an adjective by adding the suffix '*ful*' (powerful). The adverbial form is made by adding the suffix *-ly* to the adjective (powerfully). The verb 'to improve' becomes a noun by adding the suffix *-ment* (improvement). The same root word can also become a verb (improvise). The noun 'nation' changes into an adjective with the suffix *-al* (national), and by adding another suffix *-ize* the word changes from an adjective to a verb (nationalize). The adjective 'special' can change to a verb (specialize) or a noun (specialty).

2. Changes in meaning.

Affix can also change the meaning of a word. There are two types of affix; Prefix is added before a root word while suffix is added after a root word. The meaning of 'possible' is reversed with the addition of the prefix *im-* (impossible). To 'overeat' means to eat too much and if food is undercooked, it is not cooked enough.

Some suffixes commonly denote an occupation.

The verb 'to teach' is transformed into the occupation with the suffix *-er* (teacher). Both grammatical changes and changes in meaning can be applied to the same base word. Eg. The noun 'interest' can be made an adjective and given opposite meaning by adding a prefix and a suffix *-un -ing* (uninteresting).

3. Changes in pronunciation.

When prefixes and suffixes are added to root words, the word stress sometimes changes, examples Noun & verb: 'photograph'. Adjective: 'photographic'. Opposite: 'unphotographic'. Person: 'photographer'. In English the word stress is often on the third syllable from the end.

Prefixes

Prefixes are first syllables like “non-” and “re-” that have their own meaning. They combine with words to create new meanings. Pre + View = Preview (first look). Super + Star = Superstar (top player). Prefixes add meaning to thousands of words. Learn a few prefixes, and you open up the meaning of thousands of words. The four most frequent prefixes are 97% of prefixed words!

Most Common Prefixes

1. a = without: amoral, apolitical, atypical

2. ante = before: antecedent, antedate
3. anti = against, opposing: anti-war, anti-bacterial
4. arch = more extreme: arch-capitalist, arch-rebel
5. auto = self: auto-dial, auto-rotate
6. bi = two, twice: bilingual, bisect, bi-monthly
7. circum = round: circumnavigate, circumvent
8. co = with: co-author, co-edit
9. col, com, con = with: collaborate, combine, connect
10. contra, counter = against, opposing: contraception, counter-claim
11. de = opposite action: declassify, destroy
12. dia = across: diagonal, diameter
13. dis = not, opposite of: disagree, disprove, distrust, disbelief
14. dys = abnormal: dyslexia, dysfunctional
15. e = electronic: e-literate, e-book
16. eco = relating to the environment: eco-tourism, eco-disaster
17. en(m) = cause to: encode, embrace
18. equi = equal: equidistant, equilateral
19. ex = previously: ex-president, ex-student
20. extra = very: extra-bright, extra-strong
21. extra = outside: extra-curricular, extra-sensory
22. fore = before: forecast
23. hyper = having too much: hyperactive, hypersensitive
24. il, im, in, ir = not: illogical, impossible, indistinct, irrational
25. in(m) = in, movement to: input, inset, intake, implant, import
26. inter = between, connected: interrelated, interact
27. intra = within: intra-generational, intramuscular
28. kilo = thousand: kilogram, kilometer, kilowatt
29. macro = large in size or scope: macro-economics, macro-scale
30. mal = badly: malfunction, malpractice
31. micro = small in size or scope: micro-economics, micro-scale
32. mid = middle: midway
33. mis = wrongly : mistake, mistranslate, misunderstanding
34. mono = one : mono-centric, monoculture
35. multi = many : multicultural, multi-level
36. neo = based on something older but in new form : neo-classical
37. non = not : non-believer, non-competitive, nonsense
38. out = more, to a greater extent : outnumber, outlive
39. over = over/above/too much : overlook, overcook, overhead
40. post = after : post-examination, post-modern
41. pre = before : pre-industrial, preview, pre-war

42. pro = in favour of : pro-feminist, pro-liberal
43. pseudo = false : pseudo-intellectual, pseudo-science
44. quasi = almost, not quite : quasi-academic, quasi-legal
45. re = again : rediscover, redefine, rename, return
46. retro = backwards : retrogressive, retrospective
47. semi = half, partly : semicircle, semi-organic, semi-precious
48. sub = under, beneath, part of something: submarine, subsection
49. super = above, bigger : superpower, supersonic, superstar
50. trans = across : transcontinental, transcribe, transport
51. ultra = extreme : ultra-sensitive, ultrasound
52. un = not : uncertain, unusual, unscrew, unplug, unfriendly
53. under = insufficient, under, beneath : underemployed, undersea
54. well = useful, successful : well-designed, well-written

Suffixes

Suffixes for Noun

-ment-er

-ness -age

-sion -sis

-tion -ism

-ty -ity

-al -ant

-ance -sion

-hood-ship

dom -th

-ght -cess

-ful

Suffixes for Adjectives

-ful -ive

-ic -al

-able -ed

-ible -ing

-ous -ish

-y -ly

-like -some

-worthy

Suffixes for Verbs

-ize

-ise

-yse

-ate

-ent

-en

-ify

-fy

-ct

-fine

-ive

Suffixes for Adverbs

-ly

-ily

-ely

-ingly

-ist

-ic

-ee

-eer

-man

Suffixes for Professions & people

-er

-ess (female)

-or

-ian

Suffixes for University subjects

-ics

-y

-ing

-ism

Suffixes for 'Without/small'

-less

-let

What Are Suffixes?

Suffixes are letters or words combined with words to create new meanings.

1. Turn + ed = Turned (in the past)
 2. Quick + ly = quickly (how it turned)
- Suffixes add meaning to thousands of words.

Most Common Suffixes

1. -able, ible = can be done: identifiable, predictable
2. -al, ial = has property of: personal
3. -ant = having an effect: coolant, accelerant
4. -based = forming a major part of: computer-based, oil-based
5. -cy = state or quality: accuracy, literacy, urgency
6. -ed* = past verb: turned
7. -ee = person affected by something: interviewee, trainee, and addressee
8. -en = made of: golden
9. -er = comparative: higher
10. -er = one who: doer, actor
11. -est = superlative: best, biggest
12. -free = without: debt-free, pain-free
13. -ful = full of: careful, joyful
14. -hood = state, condition, period, adulthood, motherhood
15. -ic = having property of, connected with: linguistic, photographic, electric
16. -ics = study of: genetics, electronics
17. -ify = give something a quality: clarify, purify, and solidify
18. -ing = present participle: running
19. -ism = belief, behaviour : modernism, heroism
20. -ist = person with specific beliefs or behaviour : anarchist, optimist
21. -(t)ion = act, process : action
22. -(i)ty = state of : infinity, sanity
23. -(t)ive = adjective : motive, votive
24. -ize, -ise = bring about a state or condition, modernize/modernize, colonize/colonise
25. -less = without: fearless, careless, childless, and meaningless
26. -like = resembling: bird-like, child-like, and hook-like
27. -ly* = having: quickly, quietly

- 28. –ment = action, process: enjoyment
- 29. –ness = quality or state of: kindness, effectiveness, openness
- 30. –ocracy = type of ruling body: meritocracy, bureaucracy
- 31. –ocrat = person ruling: technocrat, aristocrat
- 32. –ology, -ological = study of, archaeology, biology, biological, geology, physiological
- 33. –ous = having: joyous, religious
- 34. –proof = protected against, safe from: waterproof, dustproof
- 35. –s = more than one: books
- 36. –ship = state or experience of having a specific position: professorship, leadership
- 20. –y = having: happy, windy

Assignment.

1. Add the appropriate affix to the following words below
 - a. Teach
 - b. Moral
 - c. Cook
 - d. Legal
 - e. Judge
 - f. Beauty
 - g. Wind
 - h. Fast
 - i. Responsible
 - j. Educate

LESSON 2

TOPIC: FUNDAMENTAL ELEMENTS OF PROSE

OBJECTIVES: By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

Say what the elements of prose are

Identify some fundamental elements of prose in any given text

Apply the knowledge in writing their own stories/prose

CONTENT

1. Plot: the sequence of events in a literary work [Gustav Freytag, of Freytag's Pyramid fame, enumerated a typical sequence of plot events: introduction, rising action, climax, falling action and catastrophe (now often termed denouement). Some variations of plot include flashbacks and "flash forwards." Story is the raw material of which plot is constructed. According to E.M. Forster, "the king died and the queen died" is a story, whereas "the king died and then the queen died of grief" is a plot because it emphasizes causality. *Hmmmm?*

2. Theme: not simply the subject of a literary work, but rather a statement that the text seems to be making about that subject. So the subject of a novel might be suffering; the theme, depending on the view of the individual author, might be that suffering is in God's plan and should therefore simply be accepted. English teachers make use of many synonyms for theme: main idea, gist, central concept, message, moral, lesson or perspective (to name few).

3. Motif: a unifying element in an artistic work, especially any recurrent image, symbol, theme, character type, subject or narrative detail. (Not to be confused with *motive*.) Specific colors such as green and white serve as motifs in Fitzgerald's The Great Gatsby.

4. Setting: that combination of place, historical time, and social milieu that provides the general background for the characters and plot of a literary work.

5. Narrator: a speaker through whom an author presents a narrative, often but not always a character in the work

point of view/perspective: the vantage point from which a narrative is told

first person ("I")

third person (omniscient or limited)

reliable

unreliable

6. Style: the way in which a literary work is written, the devices the author uses to express his or her thoughts and convey the work's subject matter

syntax

structure

7. Tone (voice): the attitude of the author toward the reader or the subject matter

8. Mood/Atmosphere: the general feeling created in the reader by a work at a given point.

CLASS WORK

1) Write out the plot of the text you are currently reading.

2) State the difference between the tone and mood of an author or writer.

ASSIGNMENT.

State the difference between motif and theme.

WEEK 9

LESSON 1

TOPIC: QUESTION TAG.

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to;

- 1) Define tag questions
- 2) Mention types of tag questions
- 3) Identify the correct tag to a statement.

A tag question is a grammatical structure in which a declarative or an imperative statement is turned into a question by the addition of an interrogative fragment.

A tag question is also a question added to a declarative sentence usually at the end, to engage the listener, verify that something has been understood, or confirm that an action has occurred.

The two basic rules about tag questions are: if the statement is negative, the tag must be positive. If the statement is positive the tag must be negative.

For example In the sentence "You're John, aren't you? Is turned into a question by the tag aren't you.

In English, there are four types of questions: general or yes/no questions, special questions using wh- words, choice questions, and distinctive or tag/ tail questions.

Question tags are used to keep a conversation going. You can agree or refuse to a sentence with a question tag

Affirmative sentence: He is from Germany, isn't he?

Negative sentence: He isn't from Germany, is he?

He never goes out with his dog, does he?

We have a car, don't we?

Lets take the next bus, shall we?

More examples

Students must work hard, musn't they?

You will not say no to my request, wiil you?

I love my parents, don't i?

You will go, wont you?

You speak French don't you?

Assignment

Add the necessary question tag to the following statement.

- 1) The roads are bad,
- 2) She is singing,
- 3) The teacher was angry,
- 4) The bride was happy,
- 5) He is the best Governor
- 6) There is only one God,
- 7) It could be done,

LESSON 2

TOPIC: REVIEW OF LANGUAGE SKILLS.

Skills relate to different aspects of using language, such as listening, reading, speaking, and writing. Skills are our ability to do these things. They are usually divided into two types; receptive and productive

What are receptive and productive skills?

Receptive skills are those used in understanding reading or listening.

Productive skills involve producing language; speaking or writing.

The four basic language skills are:

Listening: When people are learning a new language they first hear it spoken

Speaking: Eventually, they try to repeat what they have heard.

Reading: Later, they see the spoken language depicted symbolically in print.

Writing: Finally, they reproduce these symbols on paper.

Listening, speaking, reading and writing are the four language skills we need to develop for complete communication. Listening and reading are receptive: input, i.e. The exposure you have to authentic language in use.

Assignment.

- 1) Why is listening important in communication?
- 2) How can one develop the four skills?

TOPIC: COMPONENTS OF LETTER WRITING AND ESSAY WRITING.

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to;

1. Mention the components of composition.
2. Write short note on each component.

All composition should have three important parts. These are the introduction, the body and the conclusion. These three parts must be present in all the composition you write. Use paragraphs to make these parts stand out in your work.

INTRODUCTION

This is the section at the beginning of your writing. It summarises or sets the scene for what you are about to write.

BODY.

This is where you have the main part of your writing, that is, the points and ideas you want to pass across to the reader.

CONCLUSION.

This is the final part of your writing. It should be the final paragraph of your composition. You can conclude by summarising the important points you raised in the body of your composition. Your conclusion should be brief and interesting.

ASSIGNMENT.

Write a letter to your friend who lives in another country telling him how you intend to spend your next holiday.

LESSON 2: COMPOSITION

TOPIC: Formal and informal letter.

OBJECTIVES: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- 1) Define formal and informal letters
- 2) Write the format of these two letters.
- 3) Attempt any given question on these letters.

INFORMAL LETTER

The informal letter is a personal letter. It is a letter that is written to a friend, brother, sister, uncle, parents or any close acquaintance, discussing a personal, private or an intimate affair. There is familiarity and intimacy and the language is relaxed, sometimes chatty.

Features/Format of an informal letter

1. The address of the writer, usually written at the top right-corner of the letter.
2. The date.
3. Salutation.
4. The body of the letter
5. Conclusion.
6. Subscript or closing.

Assignment.

Write a letter to your uncle telling him to assist your parents in paying your school fees. Give him three reasons why you want him to help you.

FORMAL LETTER.

A formal letter, also known as a business letter, is a letter written in formal language with a specific structure and layout. Formal letters are generally used by businesses to communicate with other businesses and individuals.

FEATURES OF A FORMAL LETTER

Your address as the sender in the top right-hand corner;

The receiver's address on the left-hand side;

The correct opening (Dear Sir/Madam, Dear Mr Smith, Dear Editor);

Title

A suitable and precisely worded opening sentence. Avoid opening with 'I am writing to you...'

A number of well-developed paragraphs;

A firm summing up of the purpose of the letter;

Avoidance of shortened forms (e.g. I'm, don't, won't, etc.);

The use of appropriate vocabulary;

Conclusion

A suitable and appropriate signing off (e.g. 'Yours faithfully' – very formal with Dear Sir', 'Yours sincerely' – less formal with 'Dear Mr. Pit').

ASSIGNMENT

Write a letter to your Local Government Authority commenting on three health hazards in your area. Make suggestions as to how the situation can be improved.

Preposition

A **preposition** is a word that shows the relationship between a **noun or pronoun** and another word in a sentence.

In simple terms, a preposition helps us understand:

Where something is

When something happens

How something happens

Example:

The book is **on** the table.

She came **after** the lesson.

Prepositions usually come **before a noun or pronoun**.

Examples of Common Prepositions

Some common prepositions include: **in, on, at, under, above, between, beside, with, from, to, into, during, after, before**

Functions (Uses) of Prepositions

Prepositions are used to show different kinds of relationships in sentences:

Position / Place (Where?)

Shows location or position.

Examples:

The bag is **under** the chair.

The teacher is **in** the classroom.

The boy stood **beside** his friend.

Time (When?)

Shows time of an action.

Examples:

The meeting starts **at** 10 a.m.

We shall travel **in** December.

She arrived **after** the test.

Direction / Movement (Where to?)

Shows movement from one place to another.

Examples:

She is going **to** school.

The cat jumped **onto** the table.

He walked **into** the room.

Manner / Means (How?)

Shows how something is done.

Examples:

He wrote the letter **with** a pen.

She travelled **by** bus.

Types of Prepositions

Prepositions of Place

Examples: **in, on, under, between, behind, near**

The keys are **in** the drawer.

Prepositions of Time

Examples: **at, on, in, during, before, after**

The exam is **on** Monday.

Prepositions of Direction

Examples: **to, into, onto, from, across**

The children ran **across** the field.

Prepositions of Manner / Instrument

Examples: **with, by, in**

She cut the paper **with** scissors.

Compound Prepositions

These are made up of more than one word.

Examples:

because of

in front of

out of

according to

Example:

He succeeded **because of** hard work.

Prepositional Phrase

A **prepositional phrase** consists of;

A preposition + its object (noun/pronoun)

Examples:

on the table

in the classroom

under the bed

Rules for Using Prepositions

A preposition is always followed by a **noun or pronoun**.

Correct: She is fond **of music**

Wrong: She is fond **of**

Avoid unnecessary repetition:

Wrong: Where are you **at**?

Correct: Where are you?

Some prepositions depend on usage (fixed expressions): examples

Afraid **of**

Interested **in**

Good **at**

Common Errors to Avoid

He discussed **about** the issue.

He discussed the issue.

She entered **into** the room.

She entered the room.

Importance of Prepositions

Prepositions are important because they:

Make sentences clear and meaningful

Help in proper communication

Improve writing and speaking skills

Class Drill

A. Fill in the blanks with correct prepositions:

1. The cat is ____ the table.
2. We arrived ____ night.
3. She walked ____ the room.
4. The boy is sitting ____ his friend.

B. Identify the prepositions in the following sentences

1. The book is on the desk.
2. She came after the meeting.
3. He ran into the house.

Make sentences using the following: In, under, between, during

Summary

A preposition shows the relationship between words.

It usually comes before a noun or pronoun.

It expresses ideas such as **place, time, direction, and manner**.

